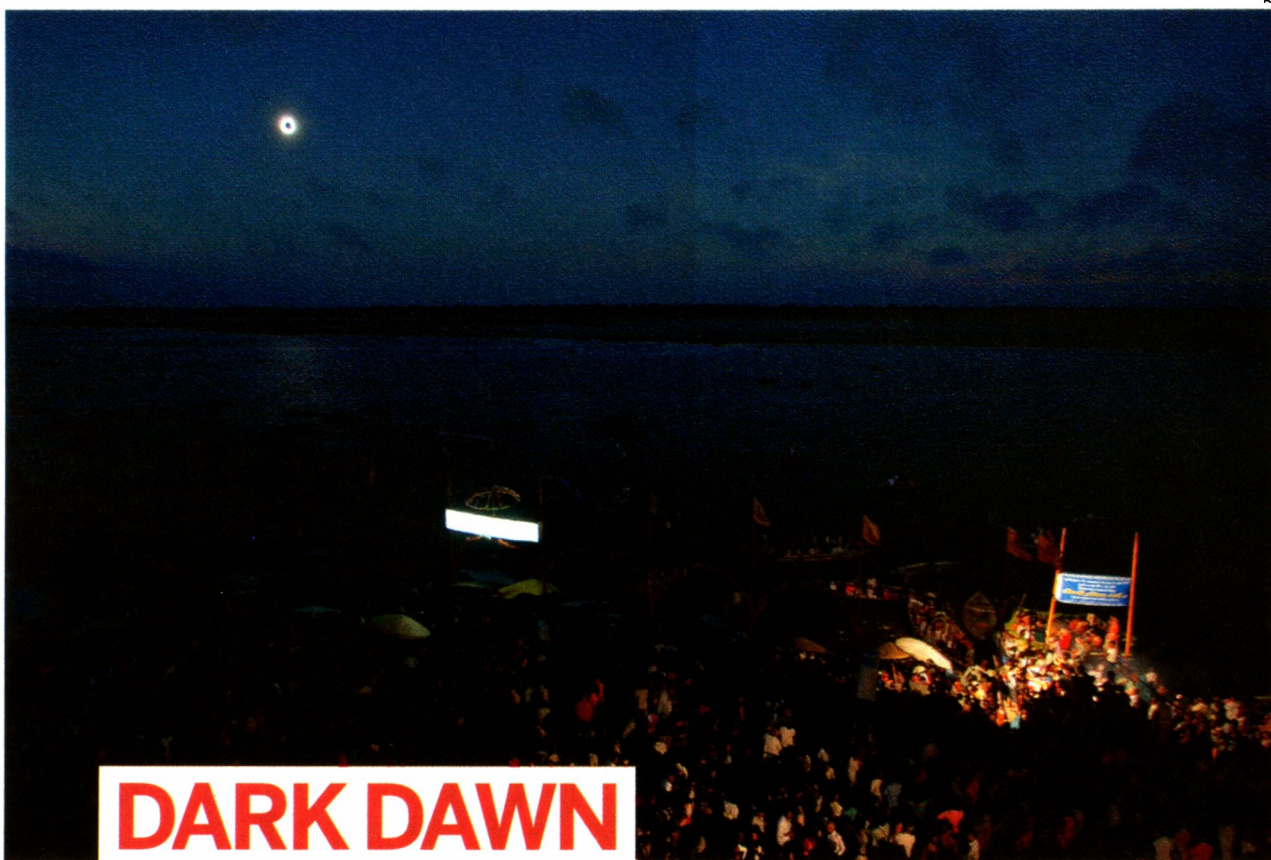




DARK DAWN

IN THE TIMELESS presence of the Ganga, the sun goes into hiding at dawn for 3.04 minutes. Thousands congregated on the banks of the river in Varanasi to witness the longest eclipse of the 21st century.

BHOPAL | Cop Shop

These days it takes an RTI petition to get a government going. After queries under the Act revealed that hundreds of policemen were transferred in Madhya Pradesh every year on political recommendations, the Shivraj Singh Chouhan Government has decided to pilot and implement a new Police Act. A petition in the Jabalpur High Court alleged that the documents received under Act indicated contempt of the Supreme Court (sc) order in the landmark PIL Prakash Singh v/s Union of India and others, prohibiting political interference in police matters. Over 600 transfers were carried out in 2008 on instructions of politicians. Despite the sc's directions, most states—including Madhya Pradesh—have dragged their feet on police reforms. Even as the Government struggles to file its reply to the notice issued by the High Court, the writ petition could change the lives of the men in khaki.

by Ambresh Mishra



OVER 600 COPS WERE TRANSFERRED ON THE RECOMMENDATIONS OF POLITICIANS IN MADHYA PRADESH.